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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions
Meeting of NSC Principals Committee
DATE: December 12, 1994
LOCATION: White House Situation Room
TIME: 2:00 - 3:20pm

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair
Anthony Lake

CIA
Director James Woolsey

OVP
Leon Fuerth

JCS
ADM. William Owens

State
Secretary Warren Christopher
David Gergen
Charles Thomas

White House
Samuel Berger
Nancy Soderberg

DOD
Secretary William Perry

NSC
Alexander Vershbow

UN
Ambassador Madeleine Albright

Summary of Conclusions

Diplomatic Strategy

1. The Principals reviewed the status of diplomatic efforts. Noting the importance of showing progress before the Congress convenes in January, the Principals agreed to press for a cease-fire and an early meeting of the parties, under Contact Group direction, that builds on the December 2 Contact Group Ministerial decisions. State will discuss this with Contact Group partners and invite the parties to attend. Action: State.

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Status of UNPROFOR

2. The Principals discussed the status of NATO planning for the withdrawal of UNPROFOR, noting that the NATO planning should be completed within a week and would be followed by a request to capitals to identify specific force contributions.

3. The Principals agreed to encourage UNPROFOR to stay and to look for ways that would contribute to a permissive withdrawal, should withdrawal become necessary, and to identify measures to improve the effectiveness of UNPROFOR in response to recent Bosnian Serb actions. Should withdrawal from Bosnia become inevitable, the Principals agreed that efforts should be made to retain UNPROFOR in Croatia and Macedonia. Action: DoD develop UNPROFOR options.

4. The Principals agreed that further discussions should be held with the French and other Allies on the possibility of reopening Sarajevo airport and a humanitarian corridor from the coast to Sarajevo (Blue Route). The U.S. approach will be to support the route opening as a French initiative to preclude the perception that we might be pressing for action which we are unwilling to support with ground forces. Further consideration should also be given to the option of disabling Serb weapons at collection sites around Sarajevo and then withdrawing UNPROFOR personnel from the sites. Action: DoD and State develop options and strategy.

5. The Principals discussed strategy following UNPROFOR withdrawal and agreed that we will continue to support a multilateral lifting of the arms embargo as the option of last resort should the Bosnian Serbs continue to reject a cease-fire and negotiations based on the Contact Group proposal. The Principals requested a round-up of the responses to last week's State cable to NATO and capitals regarding our post-withdrawal strategy. Action: State provide summary of responses by COB December 14.

Sanctions

6. The Principals discussed the upcoming 100-day decision point on extending sanctions relief for the Serbian border closure. They agreed that while the U.S. position should be based upon the facts available at the time, they do not favor an open-ended extension, preferring at most a 100-day extension.

Congressional Strategy

7. The Principals reaffirmed their desire for continued efforts to raise the awareness in Congress about the implications of a unilateral lifting of the arms embargo and to strongly oppose unilateral lift in public and in Congressional consultations. The Principals noted the possible need to use the veto to counter unilateral lift efforts.

8. The Principals discussed whether it would be politically prudent to seek or encourage Congressional authorization for U.S. participation in a NATO-led operation to support UNPROFOR withdrawal, without compromising the President's legal prerogatives to act without such authorization. They agreed to defer a decision on a recommendation to the President until further consultations with both the outgoing and incoming leadership are completed. The Principals requested an informal head-count be conducted to better understand Congressional thinking about U.S. participation in UNPROFOR withdrawal. Action: NSC and State provide summary of Congressional thinking.

9. The Principals agreed that efforts should continue to raise the awareness in Congress about our Bosnia policy and the implications of a unilateral lifting of the arms embargo. They reaffirmed that our policy will be to strongly oppose unilateral lift in public and in Congressional consultations, and to draw a distinction between unilateral and multilateral lift. It was agreed that traveling teams should offer briefings to members during the Congressional recess. Action: OSD, JCS, State and NSC to organize briefings.

Deputies Committee Meetings

10. The Principals agreed to the convening of periodic Deputies Committee meetings on Bosnia.

Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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